(continued)

productive. The tester, with great attention to detail and a focus on validation, will propose obscure edge cases and often point out scenarios that the other team members have missed. The developer will point out technical considerations, and the business analyst or product owner will be able to judge the relevance and relative value of the different scenarios. In addition, the developer will gradually obtain a much deeper understanding of the business requirements than would normally happen in a more traditional project, and this understanding becomes more and more useful as the project progresses. Often, in this approach, the three will sit around a computer and write up an initial draft of the automated scenarios together. This helps reduce the risk of information loss later on down the track.

In some teams, the business analyst prefers to do the bulk of the scenario writing, referring to stakeholders if they have any questions. This approach doesn't build a shared understanding as effectively as the previous strategies, but it can be made to work. The scenarios should be prepared by the business analyst but then reviewed with a developer and a tester. Developers can provide useful feedback on how best to express the scenarios to take advantage of the language features of the automation tooling. And testers can provide valuable input about additional scenarios that might need exploring.

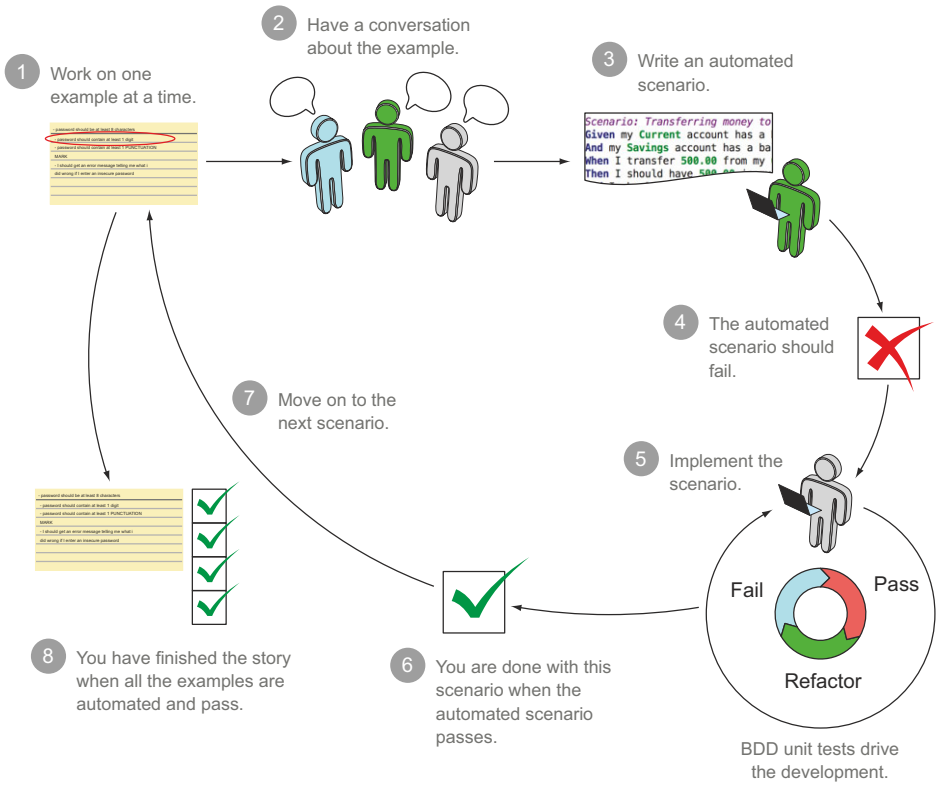


Figure 4.19 From examples to working code